

Word family: **wild / wilder / wildest / wildly / wildness / wildlife**

Base word: wild

Comparative: wilder

Superlative: wildest

Related forms: wildly, wildness

Useful compound: wildlife

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / noun (名詞 , 部分固定用法) / related adverb and noun forms (相關副詞及名詞)

Your sentence:

> “If I ever get the chance, I would love to see a sea turtle again, this time in the **wild** and for a little longer.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **the wild** means the **natural environment where animals live freely without being kept, raised, or controlled by humans**.

繁體中文: **野外; 動物在自然環境中自由生活、不受人類圈養或控制的地方**

中文翻譯:

> “...I would love to see a sea turtle again, this time in the **wild**...”

「.....我很想再看一次海龜, 而且這次是在真正的**野外 / 自然棲息環境中**.....」

Here:

in the wild = 在動物自然生活的野外環境中, 而不是在動物園、水族館或人工飼養環境中

1. **wild = living/growing naturally, not domesticated (動植物) — 野生的**

This is the central biological meaning behind your sentence.

Meaning: Living or growing naturally without being domesticated, cultivated, or controlled by humans.

Practice 1

> “We saw several **wild** animals near the forest.”

「我們在森林附近看到了幾隻**野生動物**。」

Practice 2

> “These flowers grow **wild** in the mountains.”

「這些花在山區**野生生長**。」

wild = 沒有人類馴養、栽培或控制，而在自然環境中生長 / 生活的

Common:

- * wild animal
- * wild plant
- * wild bird
- * wild species
- * wild population

2. **the wild** = natural habitat/environment (野外) — 野外；自然棲息地

This is the exact meaning used in your passage.

Practice 3 — Original

> “I would love to see a sea turtle again, this time in the **wild**.”

「我很想再看到一次海龜，而且這次是在**野外**。」

Practice 4

> “The animals were released back into the **wild**.”

「那些動物被放回**野外 / 自然棲息地**。」

Practice 5

> “Very few of these animals remain in the **wild**.”

「這些動物在**野外**只剩很少數量。」

the wild = 動物不受人類圈養或控制、在自然環境中生活的地方

This is a noun-like fixed use developed from Meaning 1.

For strict counting, I would keep it under the broad **natural/not domesticated** branch but display

it explicitly because it is extremely common.

3. **wild = uncontrolled / disorderly (行為 / 情況) — 失控的 ; 狂亂的**

Wild can describe behaviour, crowds, celebrations, movement, etc. that is difficult to control.

Practice 6

> “The celebration became **wild**.”

「慶祝活動變得非常**瘋狂 / 失控**。」

Practice 7

> “The horse became **wild** with fear.”

「那匹馬因恐懼而變得**狂亂**。」

wild = 行為、動作或情況缺乏控制，顯得猛烈、混亂或瘋狂

This is a major figurative sense.

4. **wild = extreme / very enthusiastic (情緒 / 反應) — 狂熱的 ; 極度興奮的**

A person can be **wild about** something or react with intense enthusiasm.

Practice 8

> “The audience went **wild** when the band appeared.”

「樂隊出場時，觀眾頓時**瘋狂歡呼**。」

Practice 9

> “She is **wild about** that singer.”

「她非常**迷 / 狂熱喜歡**那位歌手。」

wild = 情緒或熱情極其強烈，接近狂熱程度的

This is related to uncontrolled intensity but useful enough to show separately.

5. **wild = very unreasonable / unlikely / extreme (想法 / 猜測) — 荒唐的 ; 離譜的 ; 大膽的**

Wild can describe guesses, ideas, claims, plans, or estimates that seem extreme or unsupported.

Practice 10

> “That is just a **wild** guess.”

「那只是一個**亂猜 / 毫無根據的猜測**。」

Practice 11

> “He came up with a **wild** idea.”

「他想出了一個很**大膽 / 離奇**的想法。」

wild = 缺乏充分根據、超出一般合理範圍，或非常大膽離奇的

Common:

- * wild guess
- * wild idea
- * wild claim
- * wild estimate

This is a distinct abstract sense.

6. **wild = rough / untamed in appearance (外表 / 自然景觀) — 蓬亂的 ; 荒野般的 ; 未整理的**

Practice 12

> “His hair was **wild** after the swim.”

「游泳後他的頭髮非常**蓬亂**。」

Practice 13

> “The coastline has a **wild** beauty.”

「那片海岸有一種**原始粗獷的美**。」

****wild** = 外表、景觀或形態未經整理、控制或人工修飾，顯得自由、粗獷或凌亂******

This develops directly from the ****untamed**** concept.

7. ****wild** = harsh / exposed natural environment (自然環境) — 荒野的；原始的******

Places themselves can be ****wild**** when remote, uncultivated, or dominated by nature.

Practice 14

> “They crossed a ****wild**** mountain region.”

「他們穿越了一片****荒野般的 / 未開發的****山區。」

Practice 15

> “The island feels remote and ****wild****.”

「這座島感覺偏遠而****原始荒野****。」

****wild** = 未經大量人類開發、管理或控制，仍保留原始自然狀態的******

For strict counting, I would merge this with the natural/untamed branch.

8. ****wild** = violent / stormy / rough weather or sea (天氣 / 海況) — 狂暴的；猛烈的******

Practice 16

> “It was a ****wild**** night with strong winds.”

「那是一個風勢非常****猛烈****的夜晚。」

Practice 17

> “The sea was ****wild**** during the storm.”

「暴風期間海面非常****狂暴****。」

****wild** = 天氣、風浪等非常猛烈、不穩定、難以控制的******

This fits under the uncontrolled/intense branch rather than needing a separate core category.

Related form: **wildly**

Wildly has several useful branches.

wildly = in an uncontrolled way (瘋狂地 ; 失控地)

Practice 18

> “The branches moved **wildly** in the wind.”

「樹枝在風中**猛烈地 / 瘋狂地**擺動。」

wildly = extremely (極其)

Practice 19

> “The estimates were **wildly** inaccurate.”

「那些估算**極其不準確**。」

wildly = 以失控、猛烈或極端的方式；亦可表示程度非常高

Related form: **wildness**

Wildness means the quality of being wild.

Practice 20

> “The **wildness** of the landscape attracted hikers.”

「那片景觀的**荒野感 / 原始感**吸引了行山人士。」

Practice 21

> “There was a certain **wildness** in his behaviour.”

「他的行為帶有某種**狂野 / 不受控制感**。」

wildness = 野生、原始、狂野或失控的性質

Useful compound: **wildlife**

Wildlife means animals and sometimes plants living naturally in the wild.

Practice 22

> “The island is rich in **wildlife**.”

「這座島有豐富的**野生動物**。」

Practice 23

> “The area is important for **wildlife** conservation.”

「這個地區對**野生生物**保育很重要。」

wildlife = 在自然環境中生活的野生動物，廣義可包括其他野生生物

This is a lexicalized compound and should be treated as a useful family extension rather than another meaning of bare **wild**.

Important distinction: **wild** vs **natural**

natural

means existing or occurring through nature rather than being artificial.

wild

more specifically often means:

- * not domesticated
- * not cultivated
- * not controlled

For example:

- > natural environment
- > wild animal

A garden can be natural-looking without being truly wild.

Important distinction: **wild vs feral**

wild

can refer to animals whose species naturally lives without domestication.

feral

usually refers to domesticated animals or their descendants that have returned to living independently in the wild.

So:

> wild tiger

natural wild species.

> feral cat

domestic-cat lineage living without human control.

This is an important biology/animal vocabulary distinction.

Important distinction: **wild vs savage**

wild

is broad and can mean natural, uncontrolled, extreme, or untamed.

savage

can mean extremely violent or brutal and can sound much harsher.

For describing animals or people, **savage** may carry strongly negative or dated connotations, so **wild** is not simply interchangeable with it.

Important distinction: **wild vs crazy**

crazy

informally means very strange, extreme, or irrational.

wild

can overlap, but often emphasizes:

- * lack of control
- * intensity
- * adventurousness
- * being untamed

> wild party

> crazy idea

Both may overlap, but their typical collocations differ.

Important distinction: **wild vs uncontrolled**

uncontrolled

directly means not controlled.

wild

adds imagery of intensity, disorder, excitement, or natural untamedness.

So:

> wild crowd

is more vivid than:

> uncontrolled crowd.

Important distinction: **wild vs wilderness**

wild

can be adjective or noun-like in **the wild**.

wilderness

means a large natural area with little human development.

- > animals live in the wild
- > hike through the wilderness

So:

****the wild = 野外環境****

****wilderness = 荒野 / 大片原始自然地區****

Countability note

****Wild**** is usually an adjective.

In ****the wild****, it functions as a noun-like expression:

- > in the wild
- > return to the wild

It is not normally pluralized:

- > the wilds

does exist, but ****the wilds of...**** is a more literary expression meaning remote wilderness areas:

- > “the wilds of northern Canada”

This is lower priority.

Useful expression: ****go wild — 瘋狂起來；極度興奮****

Practice 24

- > “The crowd went ****wild****.”

「人群頓時****瘋狂起來 / 興奮得失控****。」

Practice 25

- > “The children went ****wild**** when they saw the presents.”

「孩子們看到禮物時興奮得****瘋了似的****。」

This belongs to the uncontrolled/excited sense.

Useful expression: **wild guess — 瞎猜**

Practice 26

> “I’m just making a **wild guess**.”

「我只是在**瞎猜 / 亂猜**。」

This belongs to the unsupported/extreme-idea sense.

Useful expression: **wild card — 外卡；不可預測因素**

Wild card has developed several established domain meanings, such as an entrant admitted outside the normal qualification route in sport, or an unpredictable person/factor.

Because it is highly lexicalized, I would treat **wild card** as a compound of its own rather than another bare-word meaning of **wild**.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **wild**

* **wilder**

* **wildest**

* **wildly**

* **wildness**

Useful lexicalized compound:

* **wildlife**

Useful constructions include:

* wild animal

* in the wild

* wild landscape

- * wild behaviour
- * go wild
- * wild guess
- * wild idea
- * wildly inaccurate

The Golden Manual says common figurative uses and compounds should be included, while contexts sharing one underlying semantic image should be merged rather than artificially multiplied.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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wild — animal/plant	沒有人類馴養、栽培或控制，而在自然環境中生活 / 生長的；野生的
the wild	動物在自然環境中自由生活、不受人類圈養或控制的地方；野外
wild — uncontrolled	行為、動作、情況或天氣猛烈、混亂、不受控制的
wild — extremely excited/enthusiastic	情緒或熱情極其強烈、近乎狂熱的
wild — guess/idea	缺乏充分根據、非常大膽、離奇或不太合理的
wild — landscape/appearance	未經整理、馴化或人工控制，顯得原始、粗獷或蓬亂的
wildly	失控地、猛烈地；亦可表示極其、非常
wildness	野生、原始、狂野或不受控制的性質
wildlife	在自然環境中生活的野生生物 / 野生動物

For your original sentence

> “...I would love to see a sea turtle again, this time in the ****wild****...”

The exact meaning is:

****the wild = 動物在沒有被圈養或人工控制的情況下，自然生活的野外環境****

So:

> ****see a sea turtle in the wild****

= ****在海龜真正的自然棲息地 / 野外看到牠****

This contrasts with seeing one in:

- * an aquarium
- * a zoo

* captivity

* a controlled enclosure

For your database, I would count **4 genuinely useful core meanings** for **wild**:

1. **wild/not domesticated — animals, plants, natural places**
2. **uncontrolled, chaotic, or violently intense**
3. **extremely excited or enthusiastic**
4. **unfounded/extreme — wild guess, wild idea**

I would keep **the wild** under #1 as a major noun-like construction, merge rough landscapes/untidy appearance into #1, merge wild weather into #2, and keep **wildly, wildness, wildlife**, and compounds such as **wild card** as family or lexical extensions rather than inflate the core count.